

# Data Card: African Folktales SLM

Dataset Documentation for Domain-Specific Small Language Model

| Section                | Questions from Template                                                                                                                                                                                         | Your Response                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
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| Input vs. Output       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>What are users inputting (for example, audio, text, images)?</li><li>What are the outputs or labels your model will predict or generate?</li></ul>                        | <p><b>Input:</b> Users will input text (e.g., prompts, questions about themes, requests for specific regional stories) and optionally audio (for indigenous language speech-to-text processing).</p> <p><b>Output:</b> The model will generate text-based authentic African folktales, contextual explanations of moral lessons, cultural history, and translations/transliterations in both local languages and English/French.</p>                                                     |
| Classification problem | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>What is the classification task, if any?</li><li>What categories or classes are you working with, and why?</li></ul>                                                      | <p><b>Task:</b> Categorizing folktales by origin, theme, and language.</p> <p><b>Classes:</b> Region (e.g., West Africa, East Africa), Ethnolinguistic Group (e.g., Yoruba, Zulu, Ashanti), Moral Theme (e.g., bravery, greed, wisdom), and Character Archetypes (e.g., Anansi the Spider, the Trickster Hare).</p> <p><b>Why:</b> To enable precise educational retrieval and ensure stories are accurately attributed to their specific cultural origins, avoiding homogenization.</p> |
| Labeling               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Where do your labels come from—domain experts, community members, crowd workers, AI-generated sources?</li><li>How will you check for consistency and accuracy?</li></ul> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

| Section                      | Questions from Template                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Your Response                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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|                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <p><b>Sources:</b> Labels will come primarily from community members (elders, traditional storykeepers) and domain experts (cultural anthropologists and native linguists).</p> <p><b>Consistency:</b> We will implement a human-in-the-loop review system featuring multi-annotator agreement. Discrepancies will be resolved by community councils to guarantee cultural authenticity and linguistic accuracy.</p>                                                                                          |
| <b>Data creation</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <i>How will you collect your data?</i></li> <li>• <i>Will it come from direct sources (like interviews or recordings), or will you synthesize data in low-resource settings?</i></li> </ul>                                                                                  | <p><b>Collection:</b> Direct sources will include oral history recordings, transcribed interviews with community elders, and curated submissions from partner NGOs. We will also incorporate verified public domain folklore archives.</p> <p><b>Synthesis:</b> For highly under-resourced languages, we will use carefully constrained synthetic data generation (e.g., back-translation techniques) to expand vocabulary representation, strictly audited by native speakers to prevent semantic drift.</p> |
| <b>Web collection ethics</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <i>Do you plan to source data from the web?</i></li> <li>• <i>If yes, which sites or platforms?</i></li> <li>• <i>What tools will you use - AI tools, human workers, or both?</i></li> <li>• <i>Have you addressed issues of consent, copyright, and privacy?</i></li> </ul> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

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|                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <p><b>Sourcing:</b> Yes, from open-access digital libraries, university ethnography archives, and Project Gutenberg.</p> <p><b>Tools:</b> Both human curation and automated extraction scripts (respecting robots .txt and rate limits).</p> <p><b>Ethics:</b> We strictly limit ingestion to Public Domain or Creative Commons licensed texts. For contemporary community-hosted sites, explicit opt-in consent will be obtained. Personal identifiers of modern storytellers will only be retained if they explicitly request attribution.</p> |
| <b>Bias and representation</b>        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <i>Who might be left out of your dataset?</i></li> <li>• <i>How will you ensure that the dataset reflects the diversity of the community and includes underrepresented voices?</i></li> </ul> | <p><b>Excluded Groups:</b> Deeply rural communities without internet access or written digital footprints, and minority ethnic groups with endangered languages, risk being left out.</p> <p><b>Mitigation:</b> We will partner with local community radio networks and grassroots organizations to conduct offline oral data collection. We will purposefully over-sample smaller ethnolinguistic groups to prevent dominant languages (like Swahili or Hausa) from overshadowing minority voices.</p>                                          |
| <b>Values and community alignment</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <i>How does your dataset design reflect the values you identified in your problem statement?</i></li> </ul>                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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|         |                         | <p>Our dataset design mirrors our core values directly:</p> <p><b>Cultural Preservation &amp; Inclusivity:</b> By prioritizing minority languages and diverse regional tales rather than a pan-African monolith.</p> <p><b>Transparency:</b> By rigorously tagging data origins so end-users know exactly which community a story belongs to.</p> <p><b>Respect for IP:</b> By building a consent-first pipeline that treats oral histories as the intellectual property of the source communities, avoiding extractive practices.</p> |